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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
18/908,424	10/07/2024	Yu Fang	SONA-0006-U01-C01-C03	6591

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EXAMINER
KASSA, ELIZABETH

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2457	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
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Please find below and/or attached an Office communication concerning this application or proceeding.

The time period for reply, if any, is set in the attached communication.

Notice of the Office communication was sent electronically on above-indicated "Notification Date" to the following e-mail address(es):

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Office Action Summary	Application No. 18/908,424	Applicant(s) Fang et al.	
	Examiner ELIZABETH KASSA	Art Unit 2457	AIA (First Inventor to File) Status Yes

-- The MAILING DATE of this communication appears on the cover sheet with the correspondence address --

Period for Reply

A SHORTENED STATUTORY PERIOD FOR REPLY IS SET TO EXPIRE 3 MONTHS FROM THE MAILING DATE OF THIS COMMUNICATION.

- Extensions of time may be available under the provisions of 37 CFR 1.136(a). In no event, however, may a reply be timely filed after SIX (6) MONTHS from the mailing date of this communication.
- If NO period for reply is specified above, the maximum statutory period will apply and will expire SIX (6) MONTHS from the mailing date of this communication.
- Failure to reply within the set or extended period for reply will, by statute, cause the application to become ABANDONED (35 U.S.C. § 133). Any reply received by the Office later than three months after the mailing date of this communication, even if timely filed, may reduce any earned patent term adjustment. See 37 CFR 1.704(b).

Status

1)☑ Responsive to communication(s) filed on 10/07/2024.

☐ A declaration(s)/affidavit(s) under **37 CFR 1.130(b)** was/were filed on _____.

2a)☐ This action is **FINAL.** 2b) ☑ This action is non-final.

3)☐ An election was made by the applicant in response to a restriction requirement set forth during the interview on _____; the restriction requirement and election have been incorporated into this action.

4)☐ Since this application is in condition for allowance except for formal matters, prosecution as to the merits is closed in accordance with the practice under *Ex parte Quayle*, 1935 C.D. 11, 453 O.G. 213.

Disposition of Claims*

5) ☑ Claim(s) 1-18 is/are pending in the application.

5a) Of the above claim(s) _____ is/are withdrawn from consideration.

6) ☐ Claim(s) _____ is/are allowed.

7) ☑ Claim(s) 1-18 is/are rejected.

8) ☐ Claim(s) _____ is/are objected to.

9) ☐ Claim(s) _____ are subject to restriction and/or election requirement

* If any claims have been determined allowable, you may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at a participating intellectual property office for the corresponding application. For more information, please see http://www.uspto.gov/patents/init_events/pph/index.jsp or send an inquiry to **PPHfeedback@uspto.gov.**

Application Papers

10)☐ The specification is objected to by the Examiner.

11)☑ The drawing(s) filed on 10/07/2024 is/are: a)☑ accepted or b)☐ objected to by the Examiner.

Applicant may not request that any objection to the drawing(s) be held in abeyance. See 37 CFR 1.85(a).

Replacement drawing sheet(s) including the correction is required if the drawing(s) is objected to. See 37 CFR 1.121(d).

Priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119

12)☐ Acknowledgment is made of a claim for foreign priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a)-(d) or (f).

Certified copies:

a)☐ All b)☐ Some** c)☐ None of the:

1.☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received.

2.☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received in Application No. _____.

3.☐ Copies of the certified copies of the priority documents have been received in this National Stage application from the International Bureau (PCT Rule 17.2(a)).

** See the attached detailed Office action for a list of the certified copies not received.

Attachment(s)

1) ☑ Notice of References Cited (PTO-892)

2) ☑ Information Disclosure Statement(s) (PTO/SB/08a and/or PTO/SB/08b) Paper No(s)/Mail Date 01/07/2025, 01/07/2025.

3) ☐ Interview Summary (PTO-413) Paper No(s)/Mail Date _____.

4) ☐ Other: _____.

DETAILED ACTION

Notice of Pre-AIA or AIA Status

1. The present application, filed on or after March 16, 2013, is being examined under the first inventor to file provisions of the AIA.

2. Claims 1- 18 have been presented for examination and are rejected.

Information Disclosure Statement

3. The information disclosure statements (IDS) submitted on 01/07/2025 and 01/07/2025. The submission is in compliance with the provisions of 37 CFR 1.97. Accordingly, the information disclosure statement is being considered by the examiner.

Double Patenting

4. The nonstatutory double patenting rejection is based on a judicially created doctrine grounded in public policy (a policy reflected in the statute) so as to prevent the unjustified or improper timewise extension of the "right to exclude" granted by a patent and to prevent possible harassment by multiple assignees. A nonstatutory double patenting rejection is appropriate where the claims at issue are not identical, but at least one examined application claim is not patentably distinct from the reference claim(s) because the examined application claim is either anticipated by, or would have been obvious over, the reference claim(s). See, e.g., *In re Berg*, 140 F.3d 1428, 46 USPQ2d 1226 (Fed. Cir. 1998); *In re Goodman*, 11 F.3d 1046, 29 USPQ2d 2010 (Fed. Cir. 1993); *In re Longi*, 759 F.2d 887, 225 USPQ 645 (Fed. Cir. 1985); *In re Van Ornum*,

686 F.2d 937, 214 USPQ 761 (CCPA 1982); *In re Vogel*, 422 F.2d 438, 164 USPQ 619 (CCPA 1970); and *In re Thorington*, 418 F.2d 528, 163 USPQ 644 (CCPA 1969).

A timely filed terminal disclaimer in compliance with 37 CFR 1.321(c) or 1.321(d) may be used to overcome an actual or provisional rejection based on a nonstatutory double patenting ground provided the reference application or patent either is shown to be commonly owned with this application, or claims an invention made as a result of activities undertaken within the scope of a joint research agreement. A terminal disclaimer must be signed in compliance with 37 CFR 1.321(b).

The USPTO internet Web site contains terminal disclaimer forms which may be used. Please visit http://www.uspto.gov/forms/. The filing date of the application will determine what form should be used. A web-based eTerminal Disclaimer may be filled out completely online using web-screens. An eTerminal Disclaimer that meets all requirements is auto-processed and approved immediately upon submission. For more information about eTerminal Disclaimers, refer to http://www.uspto.gov/patents/process/file/efs/guidance/eTD-info-I.jsp.

5. Claims 1-18 are rejected on the ground of nonstatutory double patenting as being unpatentable over claims 1-15 of U.S. Patent No. US 11165651 hereinafter '651. Although the claims at issue are not identical, they are not patentably distinct from each other because the instant application claims and the patent '651 claims share the same scope with minimal differences it would have been obvious to one ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the invention to modify the instant application claims in a way to match the patent '651 claims limitation. The instant claims discloses a

converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone reduces infrastructure complexity, lower capital and operational costs, and improved performance. It combines data and storage networking, simplifying management and reducing cables, power usage, and latency.

See, the table below which shows both application claims on limitation bases.

The instant application - 18/908,424	**Patent No. US 11165651**
Claim 1 . A system, comprising: **a vehicle having a** first network zone and a second **network zone;** a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising: **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising** a network regulation **description, wherein the policy comprises a default policy value;** and **a configuration circuit structured to configure** at least one network **interface circuit in response to an external data routing description and an external data service description**; **and** **wherein the** at least one **network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone.**	**Claim 1. A system, comprising:** **a vehicle having** at least one **network zone**; **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising** an external data routing **description, wherein the policy comprises a default policy value;** **a configuration circuit structured to configure** a gatekeeper **interface circuit in response to the external data routing description and an external data service description**; the gatekeeper interface circuit interposed between the at least one network zone and at least one external communication portal selectively couplable to an external device; and **wherein the** gatekeeper **interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of a first network zone and** the at least one external communication

	portal, and to regulate communications between **end points of a second network zone** and the at least one external communication portal.
Claim 2. The system of claim 1, wherein the policy further comprises a primary policy value, and wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to configure the at least one network interface circuit in response to the primary policy value.	Claim 2. The system of claim 1, wherein the policy further comprises a primary policy value, and wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to configure the gatekeeper interface circuit in response to the primary policy value.
Claim 3. The system of claim 2, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to determine whether the primary policy value is present, and to utilize the primary policy value as the policy instead of the default policy value in response to determining the primary policy value is present.	Claim 3. The system of claim 2, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to determine whether the primary policy value is present, and to utilize the primary policy value as the policy instead of the default policy value in response to determining the primary policy value is present.
Claim 4. The system of claim 2, wherein the policy further comprises a secondary policy value, and wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to configure at least one network interface circuit in response to the secondary policy value.	Claim 4. The system of claim 2, wherein the policy further comprises a secondary policy value, and wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to configure the gatekeeper interface circuit in response to the secondary policy value.
Claim 5. The system of claim 4, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to determine whether the secondary policy value is present, and to utilize the secondary policy value as the policy instead of either the default policy value or the primary policy value, in response to determining the secondary policy value is present.	Claim 5. The system of claim 4, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to determine whether the secondary policy value is present, and to utilize the secondary policy value as the policy instead of either the default policy value or the primary policy value, in response to determining the secondary policy value is present.
Claim 6. The system of claim 4, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to apply the secondary policy	Claim 6. The system of claim 4, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to apply the secondary policy

value as the policy, and to apply consistent portions of the primary policy value as a further portion of the policy.	value as the policy, and to apply consistent portions of the primary policy value as a further portion of the policy.
Claim 7. The system of claim 2, wherein the default policy value comprises a permanent storage policy, and wherein the primary policy value comprises a tool supplied policy.	Claim 7. The system of claim 4, wherein the default policy value comprises a permanent storage policy, and wherein the primary policy value comprises a tool supplied policy.
Claim 8. The system of claim 7, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the tool supplied policy from a second external device.	Claim 9. The system of claim 8, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the tool supplied policy from a second external device.
Claim 9. The system of claim 8, wherein the second external device comprises at least one device selected from the devices consisting of: a service tool, a manufacturing tool, a web based application, and a cloud based application.	Claim 10. The system of claim 9, wherein the second external device comprises at least one device selected from the devices consisting of: a service tool, a manufacturing tool, a web based application, and a cloud based application.
Claim 11. The system of claim 10, wherein the secondary policy value comprises a post-manufacturing policy.	Claim 8. The system of claim 7, wherein the secondary policy value comprises a post- manufacturing policy.
Claim 14. The system of claim 13, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the post-manufacturing policy from the second external device.	Claim 11. The system of claim 10, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the post-manufacturing policy from the second external device.
Claim 15. The system of claim 13, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the post-manufacturing policy from a third external device.	Claim 12. The system of claim 10, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the post-manufacturing policy from a third external device.
Claim 16. The system of claim 11, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to determine whether each of the primary policy value and the secondary policy value are present, and to utilize, in order, the	Claim 13. The system of claim 8, wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to determine whether each of the primary policy value and the secondary policy value are present, and to utilize, in order, the secondary policy value, the primary policy value, or the default policy value.

secondary policy value, the primary policy value, or the default policy value.	
Claim 17. The system of claim 11, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the primary policy value from a second external device in response to the default policy value.	**Claim 14. The system of claim 8, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the primary policy value from a second external device in response to the default policy value.**
Claim 18. The system of claim 11, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the secondary policy value from a second external device in response to at least one of the primary policy value or the default policy value.	**Claim 15. The system of claim 8, wherein the policy manager circuit is further structured to interpret the secondary policy value from a second external device in response to at least one of the primary policy value or the default policy value.**

6. Claims 1-18 are rejected on the ground of nonstatutory double patenting as being unpatentable over claims 1-29 of Patent No. US 11252039 hereinafter '039. Although the claims at issue are not identical, they are not patentably distinct from each other because the instant application claims and the patent '039 claims share the same scope with minimal differences it would have been obvious to one ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the invention to modify the instant application claims in a way to match the patent '039 claims limitation. The instant application claims discloses wherein the policy comprises a default policy value. A policy manager circuit that interprets network regulation descriptions such as firewall, access control, or routing rules, using default policy values offers primarily centered on enhanced safety, security, and administrative efficiency.

See, the table below which shows both application claims on limitation bases.

The instant application - 18/908,424	Patent No. US 11252039
Claim 1. A system, comprising: a vehicle having a first network zone and a second network zone; a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising: a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description, wherein the policy comprises a default policy value; and a configuration circuit structured to configure at least one network interface circuit in response to an external data routing description and an external data service description; and wherein the at least one network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone.	Claim 1. A system, comprising: a vehicle having a first network zone and a second network zone of a different type than the first network zone; a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising: a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description; and a configuration circuit structured to configure a first network interface circuit in response to the network regulation description, and to configure a gatekeeper interface circuit in response to the network regulation description wherein the first network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone and wherein the gatekeeper interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone with at least one of an external communications portal or an external device.
Claim 9. The system of claim 8, wherein the second external device comprises at least one device selected from the devices consisting of:	Claim 7. The system of claim 5, wherein the external device comprises an application comprising at least one of:

a service tool, a manufacturing tool, **a web based application**, and **a cloud based application**.	**a cloud server based application**, **a web based application**, or a mobile device application.

7. Claims 1-18 are rejected on the ground of nonstatutory double patenting as being unpatentable over claims 1-24 of Patent No. US 12095677 hereinafter '677. Although the claims at issue are not identical, they are not patentably distinct from each other because the instant application claims and the patent '677 claims share the same scope with minimal differences it would have been obvious to one ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the invention to modify the instant application claims in a way to match the patent '677 claims limitation. The instant claims discloses wherein the policy comprises a default policy value. A policy manager circuit that interprets network regulation descriptions such as firewall, access control, or routing rules, using default policy values offers primarily centered on enhanced safety, security, and administrative efficiency.

See, the table below which shows both application claims on limitation bases.

The instant application - 18/908,424	**Patent No. US 12095677**
Claim 1 . A system, comprising: **a** vehicle **having a first network zone and a second network zone;** a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising:	Claim 1. **A system, comprising: a** mobile system **having a first network zone and a second network zone of** a different type than the first network zone;

a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description, wherein the policy comprises a default policy value; and a configuration circuit structured to configure at least one network interface circuit in response to an external data routing description and an external data service description; and wherein the at least one network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone.	a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising: a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description; a configuration circuit structured to configure a first network interface circuit in response to the network regulation description, and to configure a gatekeeper interface circuit in response to the network regulation description; wherein the first network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone; and wherein the gatekeeper interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone with at least one of an external communications portal or an external device.
Claim 9. The system of claim 8, wherein the second external device comprises at least one device selected from the devices consisting of: a service tool, a manufacturing tool, a web based application, and a cloud based application.	Claim 7. (Original) The system of claim 4, wherein the external device comprises at least one of: a cloud server based application, a web based application, or a mobile device application.

8. Claims 1-18 are rejected on the ground of nonstatutory double patenting as being unpatentable over claims 1-29 of U.S. Patent No. 12244464 hereinafter '464. Although the claims at issue are not identical, they are not patentably distinct from each other because the instant application claims and the patent '464 claims share the same scope with minimal differences it would have been obvious to one ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the invention to modify the instant application claims in a way to match the patent '464 claims limitation. The instant claims discloses wherein the policy comprises a default policy value. A policy manager circuit that interprets network regulation descriptions such as firewall, access control, or routing rules, using default policy values offers primarily centered on enhanced safety, security, and administrative efficiency.

Please the table below which shows both application claims on limitation bases.

The instant application - 18/908,424	**Patent No. US 12244464**
Claim 1 . A system, comprising: **a** vehicle **having a first network zone and a second network zone;** **a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising:** **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description,** wherein the policy comprises a default policy value; and	Claim 1. **A system comprising:** a vehicle **having a first network zone and a second network zone of** a different type than the first network zone; **a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising:** **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description** and an external communication permission value;

a configuration circuit structured to configure at least one network **interface circuit in response to** an external data routing description and an external data service description; and **wherein the at least one network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone.**	**a configuration circuit structured to configure** at least one **network interface circuit in response** to the policy and to configure a gatekeeper interface circuit in response to the policy; the at least one network interface circuit, **wherein the** at least one **network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone**; and the gatekeeper interface circuit, wherein the gatekeeper interface circuit is configured to regulate communications between: end points of at least one of the first network zone or the second network zone; and an external device.
Claim 2. The system of claim 1, wherein the policy further comprises a primary policy value, and wherein the configuration circuit is further structured to configure the at least one network interface circuit in response to the primary policy value.	**Claim 9. The system of claim 1, wherein** the policy manager circuit is further structured to receive a policy communication from the external device, and to interpret the policy by performing, in response to the policy communication, one of storing the policy or updating a stored policy.

9. Claims 1-18 are rejected on the ground of nonstatutory double patenting as being unpatentable over claims 1-29 of co-pending 18/908,478 hereinafter '478. Although the claims at issue are not identical, they are not patentably distinct from each other because the instant claims and the Co-pending '478 claims share the same scope with minimal differences that would have been obvious to one ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the invention to modify the instant claims in a way to match

the co-pending claims limitation. The instant claims discloses a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone. CND reduced infrastructure complexity, lower capital and operational costs, and improved performance. It combines data and storage networking, simplifying management and reducing cables, power usage, and latency. In addition, the instant application claims discloses wherein the policy comprises a default policy value. A policy manager circuit that interprets network regulation descriptions such as firewall, access control, or routing rules, using default policy values offers primarily centered on enhanced safety, security, and administrative efficiency.

Please see the table below which shows both application claims on limitation bases.

The instant application - 18/908,424	**Co-pending 18/908,478**
Claim 1 . A system, comprising: **a vehicle having a first network zone and a second network zone;** a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising: **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising** a network regulation description, wherein the policy comprises a default policy value; and **a configuration circuit structured to configure** at least one network **interface circuit in response to an external**	Claim 1. **A system, comprising: a vehicle having a first network zone and a second network zone of** a different type than the first network zone; **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising** an external data routing **description** and an external data service description; **a configuration circuit structured to configure** a gatekeeper **interface circuit in response to** the **external data routing description and the external data service description**;

data routing description and an external data service description; and **wherein the** at least one network **interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone**.	the gatekeeper interface circuit interposed between the first network zone and at least one external communication portal selectively couplable to an external device, and further interposed between the second network zone and the at least one external communication portal; and wherein the gatekeeper **interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and** the at least one external communication portal, and to regulate communications between **end points of the second network zone** and the at least one external communication portal.

10. Claims 1-18 are rejected on the ground of nonstatutory double patenting as being unpatentable over claims 1-29 of co-pending 18/908,498 hereinafter ‘498. Although the claims at issue are not identical, they are not patentably distinct from each other because the instant application claims and the patent ‘498 claims share the same scope with minimal differences it would have been obvious to one ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the invention to modify the instant application claims in a way to match the patent ‘498 claims limitation. The instant claims discloses wherein the policy comprises a default policy value. A policy manager circuit that interprets network regulation descriptions such as firewall, access control, or routing rules, using default policy values offers primarily centered on enhanced safety, security, and administrative efficiency. In addition, the instant application claims use the term "an

external data routing description and an external data service description", wherein the co-pending claims use the term "the policy and /or a network regulation description". However, these terms are claimed in a broad and general terms without claiming any specific details that distinguish between them and thus "an external data routing description and an external data service description" can be an example of "a network regulation description".

Please see the table below which shows both application claims on limitation bases.

The instant application - 18/908,424	**Co-pending 18/908,498**
Claim 1 . A system, comprising: **a vehicle having** a first **network** zone and a second network zone; **a converged network device (CND) interposed between the** first **network zone** and the second network zone, **the CND comprising:** **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description, wherein the policy** comprises a default policy value; and **a configuration circuit structured to configure** at least one network **interface circuit in response to** an external data routing description and an external data service description; and	Claim 1. **A system, comprising:** **a vehicle having** at least one **network zone;** **a converged network device (CND) interposed between the** at least one **network zone** and at least one of an external communication portal or a first external device, **the CND comprising:** **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description, wherein the policy** is communicated to the CND from a second external device; and **a configuration circuit structured to configure** a gatekeeper **interface circuit in response to** the policy; and

wherein the at least one network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone.	**wherein the** gatekeeper **interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the** at least one **network zone and** the at least one of the external communication portal or the first external device.

11. Claims 1-18 are rejected on the ground of nonstatutory double patenting as being unpatentable over claims 1-22 of Co-pending 18/904,768 hereinafter '768. Although the claims at issue are not identical, they are not patentably distinct from each other because the instant application claims and the patent '498 claims share the same scope with minimal differences it would have been obvious to one ordinary skill in the art before the effective filing date of the invention to modify the instant application claims in a way to match the patent '768 claims limitation. The instant claims discloses wherein the policy comprises a default policy value. A policy manager circuit that interprets network regulation descriptions such as firewall, access control, or routing rules, using default policy values offers primarily centered on enhanced safety, security, and administrative efficiency.

Please the table below which shows both application claims on limitation bases.

The instant application - 18/908,424	**Co-pending 18/904,768**
Claim 1 . A system, comprising: a vehicle **having a first network zone and a second network zone;** a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising:	Claim 1. A system, comprising: **a vehicle having a first network zone and a second network zone** of a different type than the first network zone;

a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description, wherein the policy comprises a default policy value; and **a configuration circuit structured to configure** at least one network **interface circuit in response to** an external data routing description and an external data service description; and **wherein the at least one network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone.**	**a converged network device (CND) interposed between the first network zone and the second network zone, the CND comprising**: **a policy manager circuit structured to interpret a policy comprising a network regulation description**; **a configuration circuit structured to configure** a first **network interface circuit in response to** the network regulation **description**; and **wherein** the first **network interface circuit is structured to regulate communications between end points of the first network zone and end points of the second network zone.**
Claim 9. **The system of claim** 8, **wherein the** second external device **comprises** at least one device selected from the devices consisting **of**: a service tool, a manufacturing tool, **a web based application,** and **a cloud based application**.	**Claim** 7. **The system of claim** 4, **wherein the** external device **comprises** an application comprising at least one **of:** **a cloud server-based application, a web based application,** or a mobile device application.

Conclusion

12. Any inquiry concerning this communication or earlier communications from the examiner should be directed to ELIZABETH KASSA whose telephone number is (571)270-0567. The examiner can normally be reached on Monday -Friday 9 AM -6 PM.

Examiner interviews are available via telephone, in-person, and video conferencing using a USPTO supplied web-based collaboration tool. To schedule an interview, applicant is encouraged to use the USPTO Automated Interview Request (AIR) at http://www.uspto.gov/interviewpractice.

If attempts to reach the examiner by telephone are unsuccessful, the examiner's supervisor, Ario Etienne can be reached on 517-272-4001. The fax phone number for the organization where this application or proceeding is assigned is 571-273-8300.

Information regarding the status of an application may be obtained from the Patent Application Information Retrieval (PAIR) system. Status information for published applications may be obtained from either Private PAIR or Public PAIR. Status information for unpublished applications is available through Private PAIR only. For more information about the PAIR system, see https://ppair-my.uspto.gov/pair/PrivatePair. Should you have questions on access to the Private PAIR system, contact the Electronic Business Center (EBC) at 866-217-9197 (toll-free). If you would like assistance from a USPTO Customer Service Representative or access to the automated information system, call 800-786-9199 (IN USA OR CANADA) or 571-272-1000.

03/20/2020

/ELIZABETH KASSA/
Examiner, Art Unit 2457

/ARIO ETIENNE/
Supervisory Patent Examiner, Art Unit 2457